YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Tiramisu

F G T N

Soft layers, pick-me-up empathy, your kid's own pace.

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Flow

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Gardener

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Talker

N — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Nester

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

The Harbor Takes a Breath

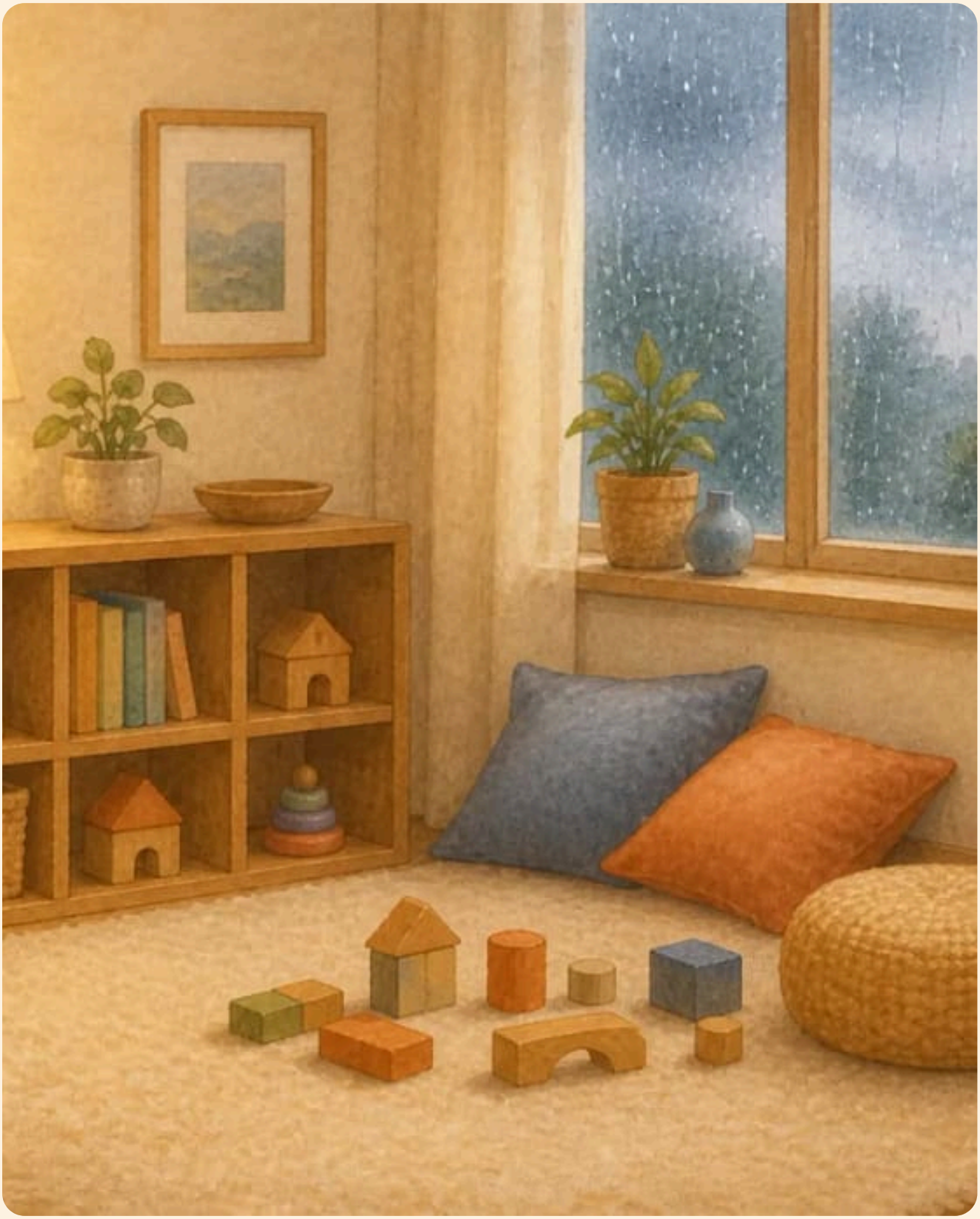
On the ride home, your child begins telling you about a friendship problem. Your phone has three work messages, dinner is not planned, and your own difficult conversation is still sitting in your chest. You listen at every red light until the words start to blur. Then guilt says: A good parent would have more room.

As a Tiramisu parent, you become a harbor for every mood. You absorb the atmosphere, soften sharp edges, and make people feel heard. But a harbor is not the whole ocean, and endless listening without somewhere to place your own feelings becomes another kind of disappearing.



You park before going inside. “I want to hear this. I need five quiet minutes so I can really listen.” You breathe, send one honest message to an adult you trust, and let your shoulders rest.

When you return, your child is still ready to talk. This time you can hear the story instead of merely surviving its sound. The pause was not abandonment. It protected the attention you wanted to give, and taught that closeness can include breathing room.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You absorb the atmosphere and become a harbor for everyone's feelings. Over time you can become exhausted, then feel guilty for wanting solitude or not being able to listen again.

RELEASE THE GUILT

Stepping away briefly is not abandonment. Listening has a capacity; protecting it is part of the relationship, not a betrayal of it.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. Deep listener, every mood has a safe harbor
2. Patience of a saint (a tired saint, but still)
3. Zero pressure, full presence

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

You absorb everyone's feelings. Schedule your own espresso break, literally. ☕

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Attachment / koala parenting



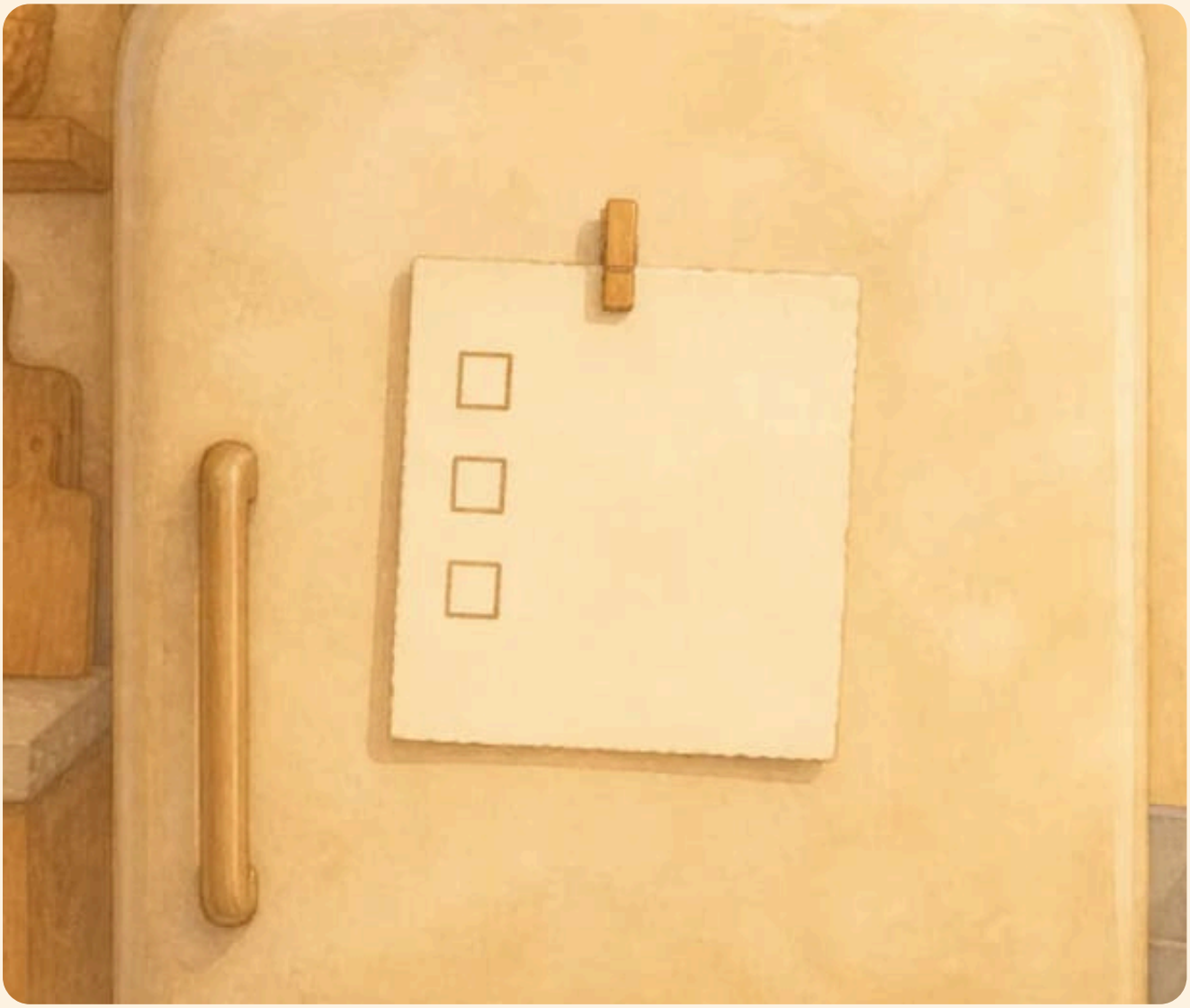
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Protect 15 minutes without conversation
- [ ] Tell one adult what you need
- [ ] Say: “I hear you. I need one breath, then we can continue.”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Write the three things that will definitely happen tomorrow, and stick it on the fridge.
- [ ] Once this week, decide without offering a choice.
- [ ] Just once, listen all the way to the end without offering a solution.
- [ ] Hold back one "be careful" today.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Deciding without a rail. Every hour asks for a fresh decision.

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Waiting and holding back. Following someone else's pace all day is work.

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Absorbing feelings. Your ears have been on shift since morning.

N — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Vigilance. Everyone's sense of safety is parked with you.

FOR YOU FIRST

Find a place where you do not have to be the container, a friend, partner, quiet room, or professional support when needed.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 10 MIN

Decide once, for the week

You are not becoming a Planner. You are refunding yourself twenty small decisions.

Choose this week's dinners, or outfits, or bath nights, in one sitting.



TIME 5 MIN

Rehearse one limit sentence

Following the child still needs a floor under it. A limit is easier to say once you've heard it in your own voice.

Say one clear limit out loud, alone, until it sounds normal: "Not today." "I need ten minutes."



TIME 5 MIN

Write it, don't say it

Not everything you feel needs to become a conversation. Some of it just needs to get out.

Write one sentence nobody will read, and don't process it with anyone today.



TIME 2 MIN

One last check, then say "enough"

Worry keeps reopening the same loop. A small ritual that closes it works better than telling yourself to stop.

Do the check once. Then say the word out loud: enough.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Your child needs empathy, but does not need you to be their only emotional regulator. Calm presence can sit beside space to try settling themselves.



0–12 MONTHS · 15 MIN

Treasure basket

Real objects are richer than plastic toys, and choosing independently is what makes the concentration last.

1. Fill a shallow basket with 5–6 real objects of different materials: wood, metal, fabric, natural.
2. Sit beside them and let them lead entirely.
3. Resist handing, demonstrating or naming unless they look up at you.

You'll need: A large wooden ring, a fabric square, a short chunky brush, a silicone cup, a metal measuring cup.

Safety first: Every object must be too big for a toilet-paper tube, unbreakable, with no coating that can flake and no cord or long handle.

Grounded in: Heuristic play / treasure basket



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Hand me the laundry

Real work, done together, with no standard to meet. Toddlers want to take part, not to be entertained.

1. Sit by the basket and hand them one item at a time.
2. Let them put it in the machine or the pile.
3. Thank them for the work, not for doing it neatly.

You'll need: The laundry you already have.

Safety first: Machine door closed and off when unattended. Keep detergent capsules completely out of the room.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



2–3 YEARS · 15 MIN

Build the calm basket together

Assembling the box while nobody is upset works far better than looking for it mid-meltdown.

1. Offer a basket and ask what helps when their feelings get big.
2. Put in whatever they say, even if it seems useless to you.
3. Name the feelings that come up as you talk, without fixing them.

You'll need: A basket, plus their choices: a soft toy, a picture, a squeeze ball, a blanket.

Safety first: Every loose item must be too large for a toilet-paper tube. Nothing that can be tied, wrapped, or pulled over the head.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



3–4 YEARS · 15 MIN

Draw anything, I'll just be here

"What is it?" makes a child guess the answer you want. Describing what you see asks nothing of them.

1. Paper and crayons, both of you at the table.
2. Describe colours, movements, choices — "you used a lot of blue there".
3. Never ask "what is it?", and never correct a colour or a shape.

You'll need: Paper and crayons.

Safety first: Use intact, non-toxic children's crayons. Stay close if your child still puts objects in their mouth.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



4–5 YEARS · 10 MIN

One sentence each

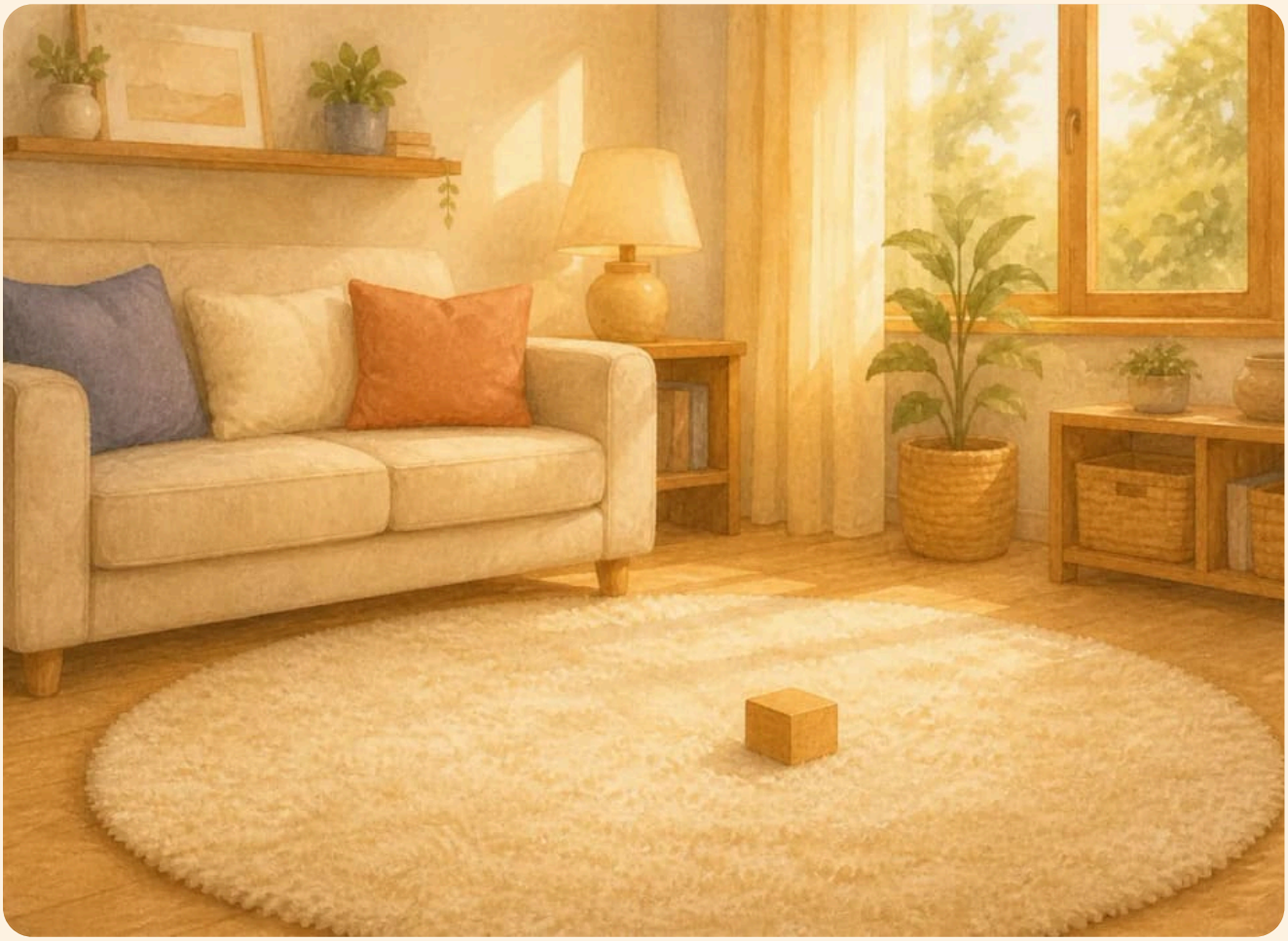
A story built by two people, slowly, before bed. Accepting their turn as it comes is another form of listening.

1. You start with one sentence, they add the next.
2. Accept every turn they take, including the ones that break your plot.
3. When they end it, it's ended.

You'll need: Nothing at all.

Safety first: If the story becomes upsetting, stop or change direction. This is not a test and never needs to be finished.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



EXPLORE PARENTEERS ACTIVITIES

https://parenteers.id/

Scan to send the quiz to someone else
https://quiz.parenteers.id/

Made with ❤️ (and cold coffee) by Parenteers · © Parenteers 2026
For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.